SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 298

WHEREAS, The Senate of the State of Texas is pleased to recognize the Texas School for the Deaf on the grand occasion of its 170th anniversary; and

WHEREAS, For 170 years, the Texas School for the Deaf has provided generations of deaf and hard-of-hearing students with a robust education rooted in shared language and culture and a welcoming environment to develop their talents, pursue their goals, and form lasting connections; and

WHEREAS, The Texas School for the Deaf has undergone many changes over the years, yet its location on South Congress Avenue in Austin has remained since it was first established by the Sixth Texas Legislature in 1856; in existence before the State Capitol nearby, it is the oldest continuously operating public school in Texas; and

WHEREAS, Over time, the school's academic opportunities have expanded from basic studies and vocational instruction to a comprehensive education that promotes personal achievement, leadership development, and career readiness; the campus also offers outreach services and resources to students attending traditional public schools, families, and audiology professionals across the state; and

WHEREAS, The institute commemorated its 170th anniversary on August 26, 2026, with a Founders Day celebration that recognized the dedication of countless students, educators, families, and advocates who have contributed to its storied history; and

WHEREAS, As the Texas School for the Deaf marks this historic milestone, its students, staff, administrators, and community members may take great pride in their collective efforts to sustain a tradition of educational distinction and a language-rich haven where deaf and hard-of-hearing Texans can learn, grow, and thrive; now, therefore, be it

PROCLAIMED, That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby commemorate the 170th anniversary of the Texas School for the Deaf and extend sincere best wishes to all associated with the school for continued success long into the future; and, be it further

PROCLAIMED, That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for the school as an expression of high regard from the Texas Senate.

Eckhardt, Zaffirini

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Member, Texas Senate

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Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

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Secretary of the Senate